



AIRLINE CABIN CREW

JOB DESCRIPTION

Airline cabin-crew members ensure that passengers experience a safe, comfortable, and enjoyable flight. Duties include checking the aircraft's cabin, greeting and seating passengers, giving safety demonstrations, and selling and serving refreshments. Cabin crew are trained to respond to emergency and security situations, and to administer first aid. They must deal with a wide range of clients and situations.



SALARY

Newly qualified cabin crew ★★★★★

Senior cabin crew ★★★☆☆

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Strong competition for jobs • Most employees work on a temporary basis—permanent contracts are more rare • Overtime and flight allowances can increase earnings

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **HOTEL MANAGER** *see pp. 304–305*
- ▶ **AIRLINE CUSTOMER SERVICE AGENT**
Checks passengers onto their flight, weighs luggage, and issues boarding passes.
- ▶ **CUSTOMER SERVICE AGENT** Answers customer queries, handles complaints, and provides information about an organization's services. A customer service agent is often a member of the public's first point of contact with a company.
- ▶ **RESORT REPRESENTATIVE** Ensures that tourists have a comfortable and pleasant vacation, meeting vacationers as their flights arrive, arranging onward transportation, and offering advice once at the resort.

Aviation is expected to expand in the next decade, with more opportunities for cabin crew, especially in Asia and South America.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Aviation • Travel and tourism • Hospitality • Working with people • English • Mathematics • Languages • Geography



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Cabin crew must have a good basic education, be at least 18, and pass fitness tests. Prior customer service experience is helpful.



LIFESTYLE Due to the 24-hour nature of air travel, cabin crew work irregular hours in shifts that include nights, weekends, and public holidays.



LOCATION Most time is spent working in the cabin of an in-flight passenger aircraft. Significant time away from home is normal in this career.



THE REALITIES Jet lag and standing for long periods make this job physically taxing. Tired or anxious passengers can be difficult to deal with.